

Intermediate Macroeconomics

ECON 3220, Fall 2026

Professor: Dr. Zhigang Feng

Office: Rm 332BB, Mammel Hall

E-mail: *zfeng@unomaha.edu*

Classroom: online

Office Hours: by appointment

Course Description and Learning Objectives

Macroeconomics studies the movements and relationships between aggregate economic variables. The discipline has two important objectives: First, it strives to understand long run paths of aggregate output (growth theory), that is, what are the determinants of sustained increases in living standards of countries? And are poorer countries catching up to rich countries? Second, it studies short run fluctuations around potential output (business cycle theory), that is, why does output fluctuate around its long run path? Also, can the government use fiscal or monetary policy to smooth out these cycles?

These are questions we will begin to answer in this class. The objective is to introduce you to macroeconomic theories of growth and business cycle by solving simple models and discussing its implications for policy.

Since modern macroeconomic theory relies heavily on microeconomic foundations, most models are set up as utility maximization problems. That is, a representative agent maximizes lifetime utility subject to a lifetime budget constraint. In order to successfully solve such models, we will have to master the technique of constraint optimization; therefore, we will have to review calculus (derivatives) and algebra.

The goal in this class is for you to make the leap from what you learned in your principles of macro course to a more substantial understanding of modern macroeconomic theory and its applications. This will give you the necessary tools to begin to successfully understand more sophisticated and specific topics in macroeconomics.

Prerequisites:

Math and basic instinct and interest about economics.

Course Requirements:

The requirements for this course are weekly homework, readings, three exams, and one presentation.

Your final grade is based on a total of 100% allocated as follows.

- **Class Tests (50%)** – There will be a total of five class tests each worth 13%. The tests are designed to test your understanding of the concepts covered in each module. The exams will consist of a multiple choice. Each exam will cover only the material covered within the module. However, you may need background knowledge of material covered in previous modules for subsequent exams.
- **Chapter Quizzes (25%)** – Part of your assessment will be based on chapter; you will complete a 10-question quiz on each chapter we complete (2%). The questions are strategically selected to test your understanding of basic economic concepts the expected learning outcomes. All quizzes will be taken online. You are also required to complete a syllabus quiz in the first week of class. This quiz is found in the orientation module and is due by 11:59 pm on Saturday of the first week of classes.
- **Other POINTS (25%)** – you can earn some other points during the course of the semester, which will be given as EZ quizzes (10%), Discussions (10%) and Reflections (5%).

Grading Scale: 97-100 **A+** 93-96.9 **A** 90-92.9 **A-** 87-89.9 **B+** 83-86.9 **B** 80-82.9 **B-**

77-79.9 **C+** 73-76.9 **C** 70-72.9 **C-** 67-69.9 **D+** 63-66.9 **D** 60-62.9 **D-**

0-59.9 **F**

Effective Fall 2002, a student may only attempt each required business core course (including ECON2220) three times. Any grade earned, excluding CR, W, NC, NR, I, IP, AU, S, U or R will count as an attempt for the three times limit. If the student does not earn a C (2.00) or better on the third attempt of that required core course, the student is no longer eligible to receive a business degree at UNO.

List of Topics

1. Measurement
 - Measuring GDP and Prices
2. A Simple Macroeconomic Model
 - Work-Leisure Decision
 - General Equilibrium

- Laffer Curve
3. Economic Growth
- Stylized Facts
 - Malthusian Model of Economic Growth
 - Solow Model of Economic Growth
 - Endogenous Growth
 - Growth Accounting
4. Consumption and Savings
- Life Cycle Decisions
 - Fiscal Policy and Ricardian Equivalence
 - Credit Market Imperfections and Financial Crisis
 - Social Security
5. Business Cycles
- Stylized Facts
 - Monetary Policy
 - Fiscal Policy

Tentative Agenda (subject to changes)

<i>Week of</i>	<i>Monday</i>	<i>Wednesday</i>	<i>Assignments</i>	<i>Due Date</i>
Aug. 25	Introduction	Ch. 2-1	Syllabus Quiz, pre-test	Sep. 8
Sep. 1	Ch. 2-2	Ch. 3	Ch. 1-2 Quiz	Sep. 15
Sep. 8	Labor Day	Review 1, Exam 1	Ch. 3 Quiz	Sep. 22
Sep. 15	Ch. 4-1	Ch. 4-2	Ch. 4 Quiz	Sep. 29
Sep. 22	Ch. 5-1	Ch. 5-2	Ch. 5 Quiz	Oct. 6
Sep. 29	Ch. 6	Review 2		
Oct. 6	Exam 2	Ch. 7-1	Ch. 6 Quiz	Oct. 13
Oct. 13	Ch. 7-2	Ch. 8	Ch. 7 Quiz	Oct. 20
Oct. 20	Fall break	Review 3	Ch. 8 Quiz	Oct. 27

<i>Week of</i>	<i>Monday</i>	<i>Wednesday</i>	<i>Assignments</i>	<i>Due Date</i>
Oct. 27	Exam 3	Ch. 9-1		
Nov. 3	Ch. 9-2	Ch. 10	Ch. 9 Quiz	Nov. 10
Nov. 10	Ch. 11-1	Ch. 11-2	Ch. 10 Quiz	Nov. 17
Nov. 17	Review 4	Exam 4	Ch. 11 Quiz	Nov. 24
Nov. 24	Ch. 12-1	Thanksgiving		
Dec. 1	Ch. 12-2	Ch. 13	Ch. 12 Quiz	Dec. 8
Dec. 8	Review 5	Exam 5	Ch. 13 Quiz, post-test	Dec. 15

Textbook

Required Textbook: *Macroeconomics*, 5th edition, by Stephen D. Williamson. You can use the earlier edition. However, we follow the indexing of the 5th edition of the book.

Course Website

Course information is available on <https://unomaha.instructure.com>.

Course Outcomes	Assessment Of Course Outcomes
Understand and describe the concepts of Scarcity, Choice, Economic Interactions, Comparative Advantage and apply to International Trade.	Students will take a class exam, complete chapter quizzes, and participate in class discussion.
Understand, describe and analyze the Measurement of the macro economy.	Students will take a class exam, complete chapter quizzes, and participate in class discussion.
Apply the concept of Macroeconomic Equilibrium determination of equilibrium price and output using Aggregate Demand and Aggregate Supply.	Students will take a class exam, complete chapter quizzes, and participate in class discussion.

Course Outcomes	Assessment Of Course Outcomes
Understand, describe and evaluate Monetary & Fiscal Policy and the Multiplier concept.	Students will take a class exam, complete chapter quizzes, and participate in class discussion.

Additional policies:

Academic Honesty and Plagiarism:

In keeping up with the general expectations regarding academic integrity at UNO, this class maintains a policy of zero tolerance on any act of academic dishonesty. Anyone caught manifesting any act of academic dishonesty in any class assignment will face disciplinary actions which could include receiving zero credit, suspension, dismissal from the course or from the school.

Late Paper/Assignment Policy:

No late assignment will be accepted in this class. I encourage you to start working on all assignments ahead of time, do not wait until the last minute to begin working on your assignments, including your project paper if applicable to this class. That said, I reserve the right to grant a student the privilege to submit their assignment late depending on the student's situation. To get this opportunity, you will need to inform me, by email, of any (potential) problems ahead of the due date. No consideration will be given to students who inform me of a problem after the due date has passed. Keep in mind however just because you informed me ahead of the due date does not guarantee that you will get the chance to submit a late assignment, it just means I will listen to you and I will examine each issue on a case by case basis. In the event that you are granted the opportunity to submit your assignment late, you will lose 25% of the score for that assignment. Lastly, you may only get one opportunity to submit late assignment. So please plan accordingly and try to stay ahead of the game.

Missed Exam/Assignment Policy:

There is absolutely zero tolerance for missing an exam or any other class assignment. You will only be allowed to make up an exam in situations of emergency or other circumstances considered to be completely beyond your control. In the event that you miss an exam, you will need to provide a written explanation and where required further proof to show why you were absent in order to get a chance for a make-up exam. You will be allowed to make-up only ONE exam, this means you CANNOT miss two or more exams, and the make-up has to be taken before the next exam. There will be NO make-up for the last exam and there will be NO retakes of any exam.

Class Participation and Attendance Policies:

You are required to attend all class meetings, and attendance is recorded at every meeting. In the event that you plan on missing a class for whatever reason, I encourage you to inform me prior to such event occurring. I encouraged you to fully participate in class and to always ask questions when in doubt. If you have any questions outside of class, you can contact me either through my school email, through the canvas email section or by visiting me during office hours, I will make sure to respond to your questions or concerns within 24 hours and no later than 36 hours. If you are in a situation in which you want to get my attention immediately, feel free to email me at z.feng2@gmail.com, please use this only if you really have to.

UNO's requirements for Academic Integrity and Behavior:

All students are required to adhere to the highest standards of academic integrity and behavior and must satisfy the UNO Academic Integrity Policy: <http://www.unomaha.edu/student-life/student-conduct-and-community-standards/policies/academic-integrity.php>, and Student Code of Conduct: <http://www.unomaha.edu/student-life/student-conduct-and-community-standards/policies/code-of-conduct.php>. It is the student's responsibility to read, understand and abide by these policies.

Support Services

ADA Accommodations: If you have emergency medical information which should be shared; or if you require assistance in case the building should be evacuated; please make an appointment to see me as soon as possible during the office hours indicated in this syllabus. Any student with a disability who may require accommodation in order to fully participate in this class should contact the Accessibility Services Center at 402.554.2872 or stop by H&K 104.

Non-discrimination Policy:

The University of Nebraska does not discriminate based on race, color, ethnicity, national origin, sex, pregnancy, sexual orientation, gender identity, religion, disability, age, genetic information, veteran status, marital status, and/or political affiliation in its programs, activities, or employment.

The University of Nebraska Omaha is committed to maintaining an environment for all students, faculty, staff, and visitors, that is fair and responsible – an environment that is based on one's ability and performance.

Additional Information:

Technical Support: You can contact technical support by following <https://www.unomaha.edu/information-technology-services/instructional-technology/canvas/students/index.php>, or by email: unohelpdesk@unomaha.edu or call: 402.554.4357